Experiment 7: Comparative Study of Popular No-Code / Low-Code Application Development Platforms

Aim

To compare popular no-code and low-code platforms and identify which is suitable for different types of applications.

Objective

- Understand the difference between no-code and low-code.
- Study the features of popular platforms.
- Compare them on a common set of criteria and give recommendations.

No-Code vs Low-Code

Point	No-Code	Low-Code
Users	Business users, non-programmers	Developers and power users
Method	Drag and drop, visual settings only	Visual tools plus custom code when needed
Flexibility	Limited to platform features	High - can extend with code
Speed	Very fast	Fast

Platforms Studied

Platform	Type	Best for	Strength	Limitation
Zoho Creator	Low-code	Business apps, workflows	Forms, reports, Deluge scripting, Zoho ecosystem	Learning curve for Deluge
Microsoft Power Apps	Low-code	Apps in Microsoft 365 organizations	Connects well with Excel, SharePoint, Teams	Licensing can be complex
Google AppSheet	No-code	Apps from Sheets / Excel data	Very quick mobile apps from spreadsheets	Less control over UI
Bubble	No-code	Web apps and startups	Flexible visual web design and database	Performance on large apps
OutSystems	Low-code	Large enterprise systems	Scalable, strong DevOps support	High cost, needs developers
Airtable	No-code	Databases and project tracking	Easy spreadsheet-like database	Limited complex logic

Comparison on Criteria

Criteria	Zoho Creator	Power Apps	AppSheet	Bubble	OutSystems
Ease of learning	Medium	Medium	Easy	Medium	Hard
Customization	High	High	Medium	High	Very High

Criteria	Zoho Creator	Power Apps	AppSheet	Bubble	OutSystems
Mobile support	Yes	Yes	Yes (strong)	Limited	Yes
Workflow automation	Strong	Strong	Good	Good	Strong
Integration	Zoho apps, REST APIs	Microsoft and many connectors	Google services	APIs and plugins	Enterprise systems
Suitable for	SMEs	Large organizations	Small teams	Startups	Enterprises

Ratings are general observations; pricing and features change often, so check each vendor's website before choosing.

Results

- For quick apps from spreadsheets, AppSheet is the easiest choice.
- For business process apps with forms, approvals and reports, Zoho Creator is a strong choice.
- Organizations using Microsoft 365 benefit most from Power Apps.
- Very large and complex systems need an enterprise platform like OutSystems.

Conclusion

No single platform is best for every case. The choice depends on the type of application, the team's skills, budget and the tools the organization already uses. No-code and low-code platforms reduce development time and cost and allow business users to build their own solutions.